CULTURE

LESSONS IN HISTORY

THE SACRED AMRITSAR, A FESTIVAL OF ARTS BEING HELD FROM FEB. 21-23, RETURNS WITH HERITAGE WALKS, MUSICAL PERFORMANCES AND STORYTELLING SESSIONS

The city of Amritsar is once again going to echo with the celebrations of mystic poets and their timeless verses. The third edition of 'The Sacred Amritsar', produced by Teamwork Arts, is back with an incredible line-up of artists, musicians and storytellers. From engaging literary sessions to musical performances and heritage walks, the festival promises to be an immersive space where audiences can connect with mystic traditions, storytelling and artistic heritage.

Sanjoy K. Roy, managing director, Teamwork Arts, says that 'The Sacred Amritsar' was envisioned as a festival that celebrates the intersection of music, poetry, history and spirituality. "Amritsar's historical landmarks, vibrant bazaars, and deep-rooted traditions create a unique atmosphere that enhances the festival's themes," he adds.

The opening night will feature a performance in honour of the late legendary qawwali singer and songwriter Ustad Nusrat Fateh Ali Khan by the Rehmat-e-Nusrat group. The stellar line-up includes Kabir Cafe, whose fusion of neo-folk and mystic poetry continues to captivate audiences; classical vocalist Kalapini Komkali who will pay a homage to her father, Pandit Kumar Gandharva; Padma Shri recipient Anwar Khan Manganiyar, whose evocative Rajasthani folk renditions promise to be mesmerising; the Hazrat Amir Khusrau Project by Abhijit Pohankar, celebrating the timeless legacy of Sufi poetry; and Dastan-e-Akhtari, where Padma Shri recipient Malini Awasthi and Yatindra Mishra will bring Begum Akhtar's life and music to the stage. The highlights on the literary front include a conversation between Navtej Sarna and Navdeep Suri, and oral historian Aanchal Malhotra's in conversation with Roy.

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Pohankar, who is performing in Amritsar for the first time, says that the people and music of Punjab have always fascinated him, just as they did his father, the legendary vocalist Pandit Ajay



STELLAR LINE-UP From left, Abhijit Pohankar, Malini Awasthi and Kalapini Komkali

PRAKASH PRABHU